BUSINESS AI STACK · CHAPTER 24

The business AI stack

A practical guide with steps, examples and a checklist. Read the chapter, then build the example.

CHAPTER 24 · BUSINESS AI STACK

The business AI stack: which tool does what, and where to learn it

Twelve tools cover most small-business automation. Each row below names the tool, the job it does for you, and where SkillNavora teaches it.

Category	Recommended tool	Your purpose	Where you learn it
Automation	n8n	Main workflow engine	Automation module (Module 20) and the n8n lessons in the agents track
Alternative automation	Make	Faster visual prototyping	Automation module (Module 20) and the Make tutorial
AI models	OpenAI API	Classification, extraction, reasoning	GenAI lessons and the AI Tools Lab
Alternative AI	Anthropic Claude API	AI workflows and document processing	Claude for daily PM work (Module 14) and Claude Code (Module 15)
Database	Supabase	Customer and workflow data	Agents and GenAI lessons; the SkillNavora LMS runs on Supabase
Backend	Python	Custom business logic	Python track in the Data Science & AI handbook
Frontend	Next.js	Customer-facing dashboards	**New: Chapter 25**
CRM	Zoho CRM	Customer management	**New: Chapter 26**
Communication	WhatsApp Business Platform	Customer messaging	**New: Chapter 27**
Analytics	Power BI	Business reporting	Power BI track in the Data Science & AI handbook
Deployment	Vercel and AWS	Application hosting	**New: Chapter 28**
Project management	Jira	Product and development tracking	**New: Chapter 29**

How the tools fit together

A typical flow: a lead arrives on your landing page (Chapter 31), it is saved in your database (Supabase), an automation (n8n or Make) adds it to your CRM (Zoho), sends a WhatsApp message (Chapter 27), and an AI model (OpenAI or Claude) reads any free-text message and sorts it. Reports go to Power BI, and the product team tracks the work in Jira.

START SMALL

Pick one flow, such as "website enquiry to WhatsApp reply". Build it end to end with two or three tools before adding the next. A working small flow beats a large plan.

Checklist before you buy any tool

- What decision or task does it replace?
- Who will use it each day, and do they need training?
- Where does the customer's data live, and can you export it?
- What does it cost at 10 times your current volume? Check each vendor's current pricing page.

Official documentation for the tools in this chapter: n8n, OpenAI API, Supabase, WhatsApp developer platform and Python. Check these first when an API detail or version has changed.